MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience spanning QA automation and test infrastructure, with recent focus on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams, reducing average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes; hands-on Kubernetes experience includes namespace-level deployments to a shared cluster and a personal k3s homelab, and Terraform experience is personal, including provisioning a Hetzner VPS; seeking a DevOps or platform engineering role.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and platforms: Terraform (personal projects), Kubernetes (namespace-level access at work; personal k3s homelab), Helm, Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Cloud learning: AWS basics (EC2, S3; personal learning)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and tools: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Linux, Git
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Built short-lived environments for each merge request using GitLab CI and Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster, with an application, PostgreSQL and seeded data.
- Set environments to be removed automatically after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use them to review changes and run end-to-end tests.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into their own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the main offenders.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wrocław | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, plus artifact publishing; improved pipeline performance from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and on-demand ephemeral environments.
- Build merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster, and my access is at namespace level.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky rate from 7% to below 1%. Write Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and maintain an internal guide to CI used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wrocław | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Education & Training

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified).